BLUE CRAYON

Version C — "The Knock"

Short cut · 13 October 2026
Running time 0:57 · One line

FADE IN:

1 EXT. APARTMENT DOORSTEP - NIGHT

Pouring rain.

The front door BANGS open. PAPA (30s, short black beard, black funeral suit) drags a small ROBOT down the steps by its arm and drops it beside the bins.

The door SLAMS.

The Robot sits in the rain. Sage-mint paint, rust, a dent in its egg-shaped head. A blue crayon is taped to one finger. It hunches over something in its lap, keeping it dry.

It looks up at the door. Reaches out. Taps with its small metal knuckles.

KNOCK-KNOCK.

2 INT. APARTMENT - FRONT HALL - NIGHT

Dark. Papa sits on the floor with his back against the door. Eyes shut.

Beside him, a pair of small red sneakers.

KNOCK-KNOCK.

He doesn't move.

On the step, the Robot's eyes flicker.

3 EXT. APARTMENT DOORSTEP - DAY (FLASHBACK)

Sunshine. KNOCK-KNOCK, small and timid. The same door opens.

THE BOY (5, curly black hair, mustard hoodie two sizes too big, red sneakers) finds the Robot on the step. Small. Scared.

He grins.

Behind him, Papa shakes his head. Points away.

The Boy grabs the Robot's hand and pulls it inside.

4 INT. LIVING ROOM - DRAWING CORNER - NIGHT (FLASHBACK)

Lamplight. The Robot pinches a blue crayon. It slips.

The Boy giggles. Tapes the crayon to its finger.

RRRIP.

The Robot's eyes curve up into two glowing arcs.

5 MONTAGE (FLASHBACK)

MUSIC: four notes on a piano.

– Two heads bent over one sheet of paper.
– The wall fills with drawings.
– Papa passes the doorway. Doesn't look.

6 INT. BOY'S BEDROOM - DAY (FLASHBACK)

Grey rain light. The Boy in bed, pale and small.

He folds a drawing and presses it into the Robot's hand.

BOY
(whispering)
Give it to Papa... when he's sad.

The Robot holds it in both hands.

SAME FRAME.

The bed is empty.

The Robot is still holding the paper.

7 EXT. APARTMENT DOORSTEP - NIGHT

Rain. The Robot knocks once more. Nothing.

It bends down and slides the folded drawing under the door.

8 INT. APARTMENT - FRONT HALL - NIGHT

The paper stops against Papa's shoe. Wet at the edges.

He stares at it. Unfolds it.

INSERT - THE DRAWING

Crayon on paper. A tall stick man, PAPA, the first P backwards, holding hands with a little round robot. Above

them, a big sun with a smiling face. Next to it, in wobbly letters: ME.

The sky is scribbled in blue.

BACK TO SCENE

Papa's jaw clamps. Holds.

It breaks.

9 EXT. APARTMENT DOORSTEP - NIGHT

The door flies open. Light spills onto the Robot, small and soaked on the step, looking up.

Papa drops to his knees in the rain and pulls it into his chest. Sobs.

OVER PAPA'S SHOULDER

The Robot. Chin on his shoulder, arms at its sides. The drawing is crumpled in Papa's fist against its back.

Rain runs down its visor like tears.

Its eyes stay wide. Still. Fixed past him on the empty hall.

MUSIC: the four notes. Only three play.

CUT TO BLACK.

BLUE CRAYON

THE END